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Kinyarwanda (Ikinyarwanda)

Bantu language spoken with about 12 million speakers who live mainly in Rwanda. It is the national language, along with French and English. It is also spoken in the Democratic Republic of Congo and Uganda. Kinyarwanda is closely related to Kikuyu, spoken in Burundi and Tanzania.

The writing system for Kinyarwanda has been in use since the 1940s, though the letters used by Roman Catholic and Protestant missions differ somewhat.

Alphabet and pronunciation

A a	B b	C c	Cy cy	D d	E e	F f	G g
[a/a:]	[β/b]	[t͡ʃ]	[c]	[d]	[e/e:]	[f]	[g/ɟ]
H h	I i	J j	Jy jy	K k	M m	N n	Ny ny
[h]	[i/i:]	[ɟ]	[j]	[k/c]	[m]	[n/ŋ]	[ɲ]
O o	P p	Pf pf	R r	S s	T t	Ts ts	U u
[o/o:]	[p]	[p͡f]	[r]	[s]	[t]	[t͡s]	[u/u:]
V v	W w	Y y	Z z				
[v]	[w]	[j]	[z]				

Other letters

bw	by	cw	dw	dy	fw	jw	mw
[bg]	[bɟ]	[t͡ʃkw]	[dgw]	[dɟ]	[fk]	[ɟgw]	[mɟ]
my	nw	pfw	pw	py	rw	ry	shw
[mɲ]	[nɟw]	[p͡fk]	[pk]	[pc]	[rgw]	[rɟ]	[ʃkw]
sw	sy	tsw	tw	ty	vw	zw	
[skw]	[sc]	[t͡skw]	[tkw]	[tc]	[vg]	[zgw]	

Notes

- K = [kʰ] before A, [kʷ] before O and U, and [k] elsewhere
- Kinyarwanda is a tonal language, but the tones are not usually indicated in writing.

[Download an alphabet chart for Kinyarwanda](#) (Excel)

Sample text

Abantu bose bavuka aliko bakwiye agaciro no kwubahwa kimwe. Bose bavukana ubwenge n'umutima, bagomba kugilirana kivandimwe.

Translation

All human beings are born free and equal in dignity and rights. They are endowed with reason and conscience and should act towards one another in a spirit of brotherhood.

(Article 1 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights)

Sample video in Kinyarwanda

WIKITONGUES: Daisy speaking Kinyarwanda

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Information about the Kinyarwanda language

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kinyarwanda_language

http://www.ethnologue.com/show_language.asp?code=kin

<http://kinyarwanda.ijuru.com>

Kinyarwanda lessons

<https://sites.google.com/a/wisc.edu/learning-kinyarwanda/>

<https://kigalinews.wordpress.com/learn-kinyarwanda/>

https://files.peacecorps.gov/multimedia/audio/languagelessons/rwanda/RW_Kinyarwanda_Language_Lessons.p

<https://quizlet.com/6617305/kinyarwanda-lessons-1-10-flash-cards/>

<https://www.livelingua.com/project/fsi/Kirundi/>

Kinyarwanda phrases

<http://gordanondera.wikispaces.com/Kinyarwanda+phrases>

<http://morganinafrica.blogspot.co.uk/2006/02/rwandan-dictionary-kinyarwanda-english.html>

<http://www.flashcardexchange.com/cards/kinyarwanda-common-phrases-2050070>

<http://www.musanze.com/helpful-phrases/>

Online Kinyarwanda-English dictionary

<http://kinyarwanda.net>

Online news in Kinyarwanda

<http://www.bbc.co.uk/greatlakes/>

Bantu languages

Aka, Aushi, Bafaw-Balong, Bangi, Bangubangu, Basaa, Bemba, Bembe, Bena, Benga, Bhaca, Bila, Bube, Budu, Bujeba, Bukusu, Bulu, Bushong, Central Kilimanjaro, Central Teke, Chichewa, Chokwe, Chopi, Chuwabu, Comorian, Dciriku, Digo, Duala, Eton, Ewondo, Fang, Fuliru, Fwe, Ganda/Luganda, Giriama, Gogo, Gungu, Gusii, Gwere, Gyele, Ha, Haya, Hehe, Herero, Ibinda, Idaxo-Isuxa-Tiriki, Ikizu, Ikoma, Jita, Kabwa, Kako, Kalanga, Kamba, Kanyok, Kgalagadi, Kiga, Kikuyu, Kimbundu, Kinyarwanda, Kirundi, Kisi, Kobo, Kogo, Komo, Kongo, Konjo, Koti, Kuhane, Kukuya, Kunda, Kuria, Kwambi, Kwangali, Kwasio, Lambya, Lega, Lengola, Lingala, Loma, Lomwe, Lozi, Luba-Katanga, Luchazi,

Lunda, Luvale, Luyana, Makaa, Makonde, Makhuwa, Mandekan, Maore, Masaaba, Mbama, Mbere, Mbosi, Mbugu, Mbukushu, Mbunda, Mbuun, Mende, Mongo, Mpiemo, Mushungulu, Mwani, Myene, Nambya, Nande, Ndau, Ndonga, Ngoni, Ngwii, Njebi, Nkore, North Teke, Northern Ndebele (South Africa), Northern Ndebele (Zimbabwe), Northern Sotho, Nyamwezi, Nyakyusa, Nyemba, Nyole, Nyoro, Nyungwe, Nzadi, Oroko, OshiWambo, Pagibete, Pare, Phuthi, Punu, Rangi, Ronga, Safwa, Seki, Sena, Sengele, Shambala, Shi, Shona, Soga, Songe, Southern Ndebele, Southern Sotho, Suba, Sukuma,

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